



△ Pancho Villa and his fighters

1910 MEXICAN REVOLUTION

Under Mexican dictator Porfirio Díaz, poverty became widespread and opposition was crushed. Reformer Francisco I. Madero stood for election against Díaz but was jailed. Managing to escape, he called for an armed revolution. Guerrilla peasant armies led by Emiliano Zapata and Pancho Villa attacked wealthy landowners, seized towns, and battled presidential forces. Díaz was ousted and by 1911 Madero was president.

1910

1911 Norwegian Roald Amundsen becomes the first man to reach the South Pole, beating British Robert Scott

1910 Black American activist William Edward Burghardt Du Bois is one of the founders of the National Association for the Advancement of Colored People

1911 The Inca city of Machu Picchu is rediscovered by US archaeologist Hiram Bingham

1912 THE TITANIC SINKS

Completed in 1911, the RMS *Titanic* was the world's largest, most luxurious ocean liner. With 16 watertight compartments in the hull, it was believed to be unsinkable. However, four days into its maiden voyage from Southampton to New York, it collided with a large iceberg, which tore gashes in the starboard side. In less than three hours the *Titanic* sank with the loss of 1,500 lives.



△ Titanic promotional poster



1911 QING DYNASTY IS OVERTHROWN

After more than 2,000 years, Imperial China came to an end when nationalist forces overthrew the Manchu-led Qing dynasty. This followed increasing unrest in China as revolutionary and nationalist groups protested Qing corruption, conservatism, and inability to prevent foreign intervention. The nationalist Kuomintang Party, led by Sun Yat-sen, staged an uprising that sparked revolts. The Nationalists declared a republic, the Qing emperor abdicated, and Sun Yat-sen became provisional president.

◁ Postcard depicting revolutionary leaders and scenes